

COMPLETE CHESS LEARNING LIBRARY

The Complete Sicilian Defense

A family map of major systems, structures, breaks, and Black's counterplay

COURSE BOOK

30 focused chapters - model positions - decision rules - retrieval practice

Designed to change what you notice, calculate, remember, and do at the board.

How to Use This Course

ONE CHAPTER, FOUR PASSES

1. Read the position without moving pieces. 2. State your plan and the opponent's counterplay. 3. Study the decision rules. 4. Close the book and reconstruct the position from memory.

RETRIEVAL SCHEDULE

Review the chapter the next day, one week later, and after a game that reaches a similar structure. Retrieval is more valuable than rereading.

BOARD ROUTINE

Opponent's threat - forcing moves - loose pieces - worst piece - central break - best reply - choose and stop.

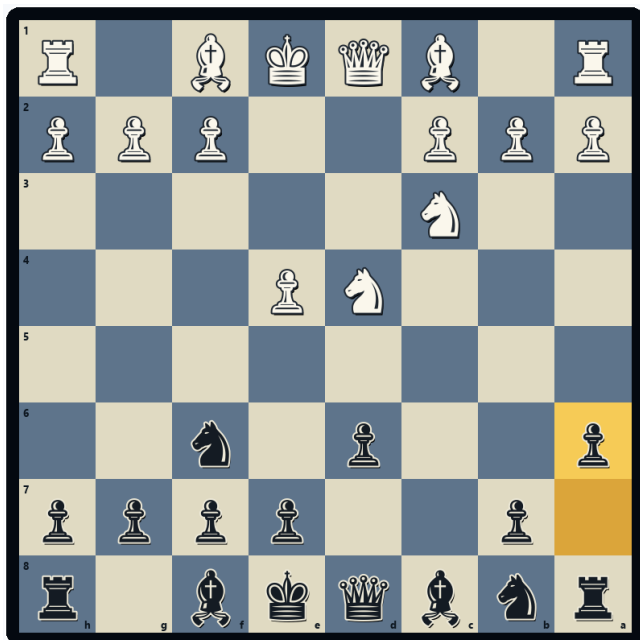
The course book explains each model position. The separate workbook forces recall, prediction, and self-scoring. Use the book first, then attempt the matching workbook page without looking back.

Engine evaluations are intentionally not the lesson. The aim is to store human decision rules that remain useful when the exact move order changes.

Course Map

MODULE	CHAPTERS
02 - Najdorf Systems	6
03 - Dragon Systems	5
04 - Classical and Scheveningen	4
05 - Taimanov Kan and Four Knights	5
06 - Sveshnikov and Kalashnikov	3
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01. Najdorf Starting Position



02 - Najdorf Systems

READ THE POSITION

Black prevents Nb5, keeps the e-pawn flexible, and prepares queenside expansion from an intentionally compact position.

PRIMARY PLAN

Develop with ...e6 or ...e5 according to White's setup, then create ...b5 or ...d5 counterplay.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White uses rapid development and may castle long before Black completes the queenside.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6

MEMORY RULE

Najdorf: ...a6 buys flexibility; spend it on a timely central or queenside break.

01. Decision Framework

Najdorf Starting Position

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Do not play ...b5 when e6, b6, or the c-file allows a forcing tactical entry.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

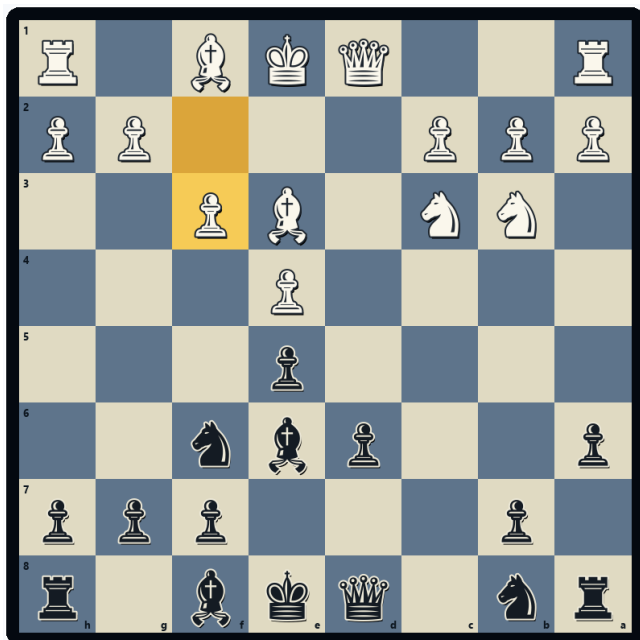
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Najdorf: ...a6 buys flexibility; spend it on a timely central or queenside break.

02. Najdorf English Attack



02 - Najdorf Systems

READ THE POSITION

White builds Be3-f3-Qd2 for long castling while Black fixes the center with ...e5.

PRIMARY PLAN

Use ...Be6, ...Be7, ...Nbd7, and ...b5 while controlling d5 and watching the king's destination.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White seeks g4-g5, long castling, and a direct kingside pawn race.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Be3 e5 7. Nb3 Be6 8. f3

MEMORY RULE

English Attack: secure d5, locate the white king, then race with calculation.

02. Decision Framework

Najdorf English Attack

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	A queenside pawn push is too slow if White can open the g- or h-file with tempo.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

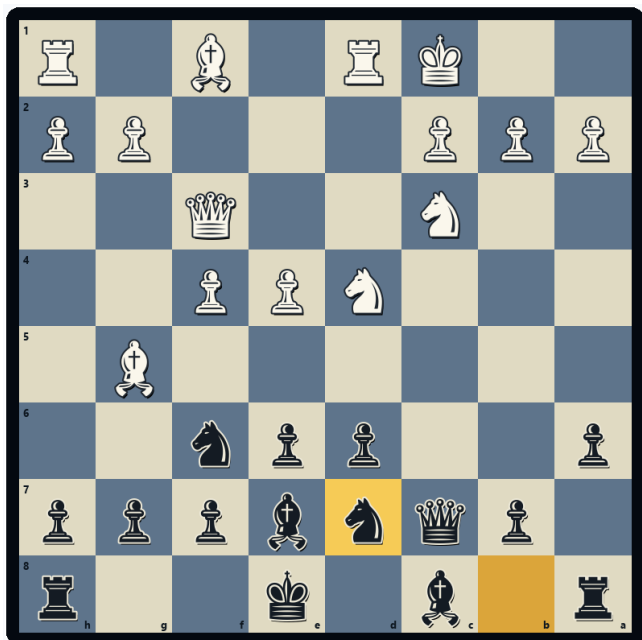
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5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: English Attack: secure d5, locate the white king, then race with calculation.

03. Najdorf 6.Bg5 Main Line



02 - Najdorf Systems

READ THE POSITION

White pins the f6-knight and builds e5 pressure while Black develops behind a Scheveningen center.

PRIMARY PLAN

Break the pin safely, complete development, and use ...b5 or ...e5 only after checking the central tactics.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White threatens e5, f5, and sacrifices on e6 or f6 when Black falls behind.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Bg5 e6 7. f4 Be7 8. Qf3 Qc7 9. O-O-O Nbd7

MEMORY RULE

Bg5 Najdorf: solve the pin before launching the queenside.

03. Decision Framework

Najdorf 6.Bg5 Main Line

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	The f6-knight may be pinned, overloaded, or the only defender of d5 and h5.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

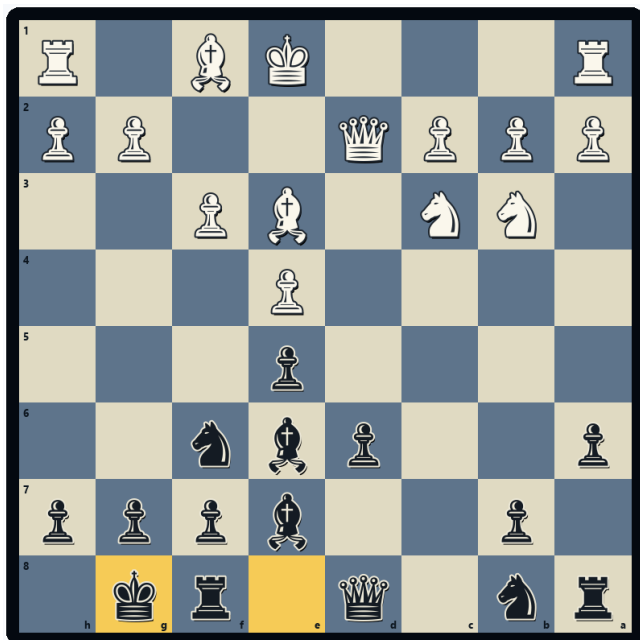
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5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Bg5 Najdorf: solve the pin before launching the queenside.

04. Najdorf 6.Be3 with ...e5



02 - Najdorf Systems

READ THE POSITION

Black gains central space with ...e5 and accepts a long-term contest over d5.

PRIMARY PLAN

Hold d5, improve the b8-knight through d7, and create queenside play before White's pawn storm lands.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White aims for long castling, g4, and a knight occupation of d5.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Be3 e5 7. Nb3 Be6 8. f3 Be7 9. Qd2 O-O

MEMORY RULE

Najdorf ...e5: d5 is the price of space, so budget every piece around it.

04. Decision Framework

Najdorf 6.Be3 with ...e5

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Exchanging the wrong minor piece can give White an uncontested d5-knight.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

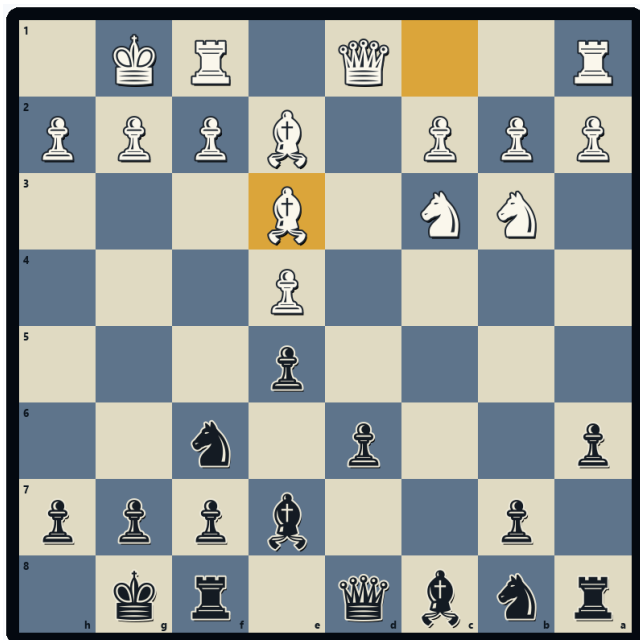
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5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Najdorf ...e5: d5 is the price of space, so budget every piece around it.

05. Najdorf Classical 6.Be2



02 - Najdorf Systems

READ THE POSITION

White castles short and emphasizes central control rather than an immediate pawn race.

PRIMARY PLAN

Finish development, use ...Be6 or ...b5, and prepare ...Nbd7-b6-c4 or the freeing ...d5 break.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White can use f4, a4, or Nd5 while Black maneuvers.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Be2 e5 7. Nb3 Be7 8. O-O O-O 9. Be3

MEMORY RULE

Classical Najdorf: build activity without inventing a race that White did not start.

05. Decision Framework

Najdorf Classical 6.Be2

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	A routine ...b5 can lose the b-pawn or allow a4 to fix the queenside.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

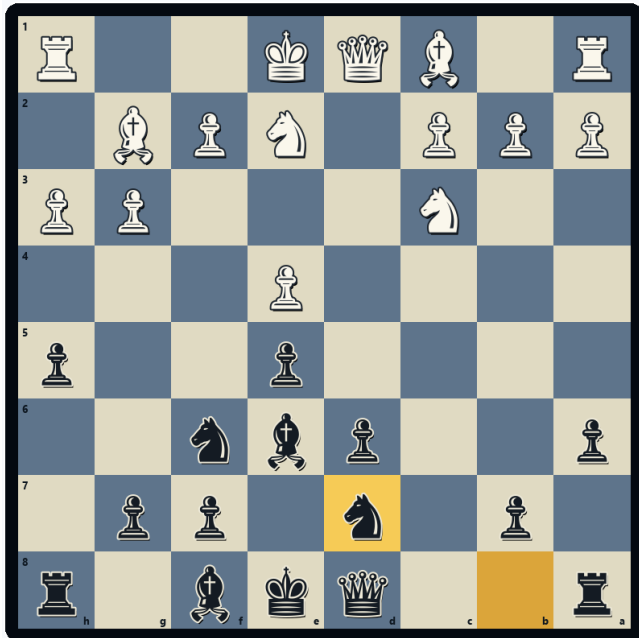
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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Classical Najdorf: build activity without inventing a race that White did not start.

06. Najdorf 6.h3



02 - Najdorf Systems

READ THE POSITION

White keeps several setups available while preventing ...Ng4 and preparing g4 or a quieter center.

PRIMARY PLAN

Use ...h5 to restrain g4 when justified, develop efficiently, and keep ...d5 as the strategic test.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White can choose g3, f4, or a delayed long-castling attack.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. h3 e5 7. Nde2 h5 8. g3 Be6 9. Bg2 Nbd7

MEMORY RULE

Najdorf h3: restrain one plan without creating a permanent target.

06. Decision Framework

Najdorf 6.h3

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	The h-pawn becomes a hook if Black cannot control g5 and the dark squares.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

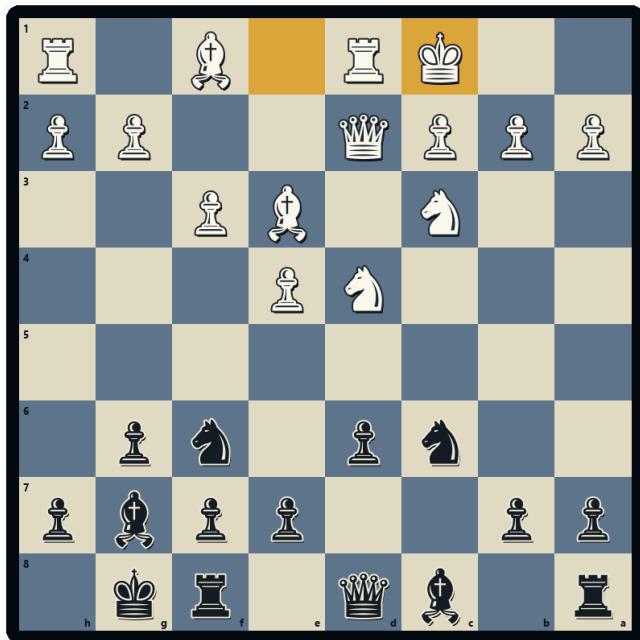
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3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Najdorf h3: restrain one plan without creating a permanent target.

07. Dragon Yugoslav Attack



03 - Dragon Systems

READ THE POSITION

Opposite-side castling creates a forcing race between White's h-pawn attack and Black's c-file pressure.

PRIMARY PLAN

Use ...Rc8, ...Ne5 or ...Be6, and queenside pawn contact while calculating White's forcing checks.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White seeks h4-h5, Bh6, and sacrifices against the castled king.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 g6 6. Be3 Bg7 7. f3 O-O 8. Qd2 Nc6 9. O-O-O

MEMORY RULE

Yugoslav Dragon: compare forcing moves, not the number of pawns advanced.

07. Decision Framework

Dragon Yugoslav Attack

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	A single tempo spent on a decorative move can decide the pawn race.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

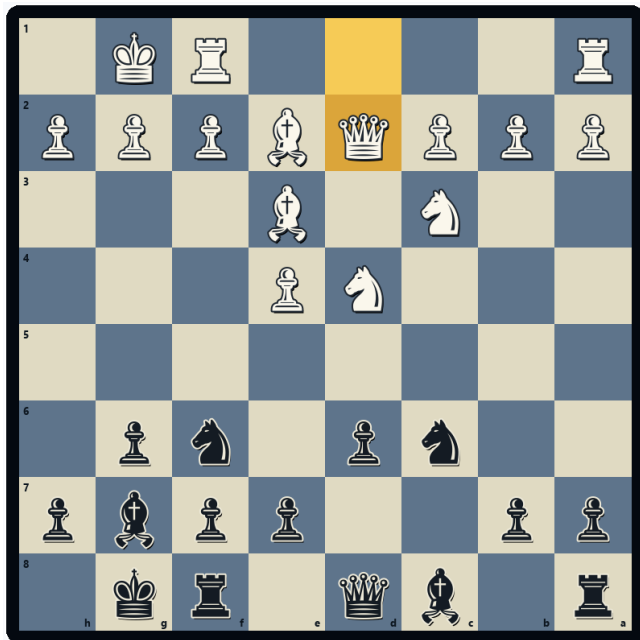
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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Yugoslav Dragon: compare forcing moves, not the number of pawns advanced.

08. Dragon Classical System



03 - Dragon Systems

READ THE POSITION

White castles short and builds central control while Black obtains the long g7 diagonal.

PRIMARY PLAN

Pressure d4, use ...Be6 and ...Rc8, and seek ...d5 when the center permits it.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White may play f4, Rad1, and Nd5 without exposing the king to a pawn race.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 g6 6. Be2 Bg7 7. O-O O-O 8. Be3 Nc6 9. Qd2

MEMORY RULE

Classical Dragon: pressure d4 first; attack only when the center cooperates.

08. Decision Framework

Dragon Classical System

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Trading on d4 can activate White's queen or c-pawn if the recapture is not examined.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

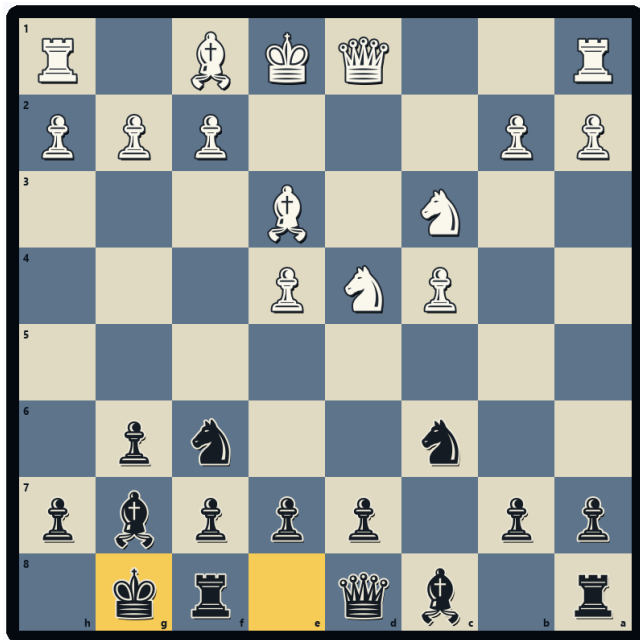
ACTIVE RECALL

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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Classical Dragon: pressure d4 first; attack only when the center cooperates.

09. Accelerated Dragon Maroczy Bind



03 - Dragon Systems

READ THE POSITION

White's c4-e4 bind restrains ...d5 but leaves long-term dark-square and pawn targets.

PRIMARY PLAN

Attack the bind with ...d6, ...Nd7-c5, ...a5, and a prepared ...f5 or ...d5 break.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White squeezes space, controls d5, and tries to prevent all freeing moves.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 g6 5. c4 Bg7 6. Be3 Nf6 7. Nc3 O-O

MEMORY RULE

Maroczy: improve every piece until the freeing break is tactically real.

09. Decision Framework

Accelerated Dragon Maroczy Bind

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	A premature ...d5 can simply lose a pawn because c4 and e4 control the key recaptures.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

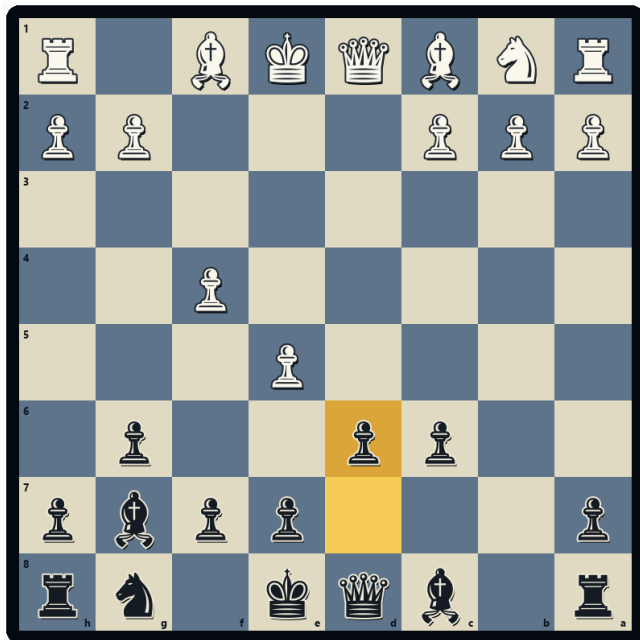
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3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Maroczy: improve every piece until the freeing break is tactically real.

10. Accelerated Dragon Exchange on c6



03 - Dragon Systems

READ THE POSITION

White damages the c-pawns but gives Black open files and central targets.

PRIMARY PLAN

Use the b-file, pressure e5, and complete development before trying to prove the bishop pair.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White uses the advanced e5-pawn to gain tempi and target the dark squares.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 g6 5. Nxc6 bxc6 6. e5 Bg7 7. f4 d6

MEMORY RULE

Exchange Dragon: open files are compensation only when rooks can reach them.

10. Decision Framework

Accelerated Dragon Exchange on c6

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	The e5-pawn can gain time, but Black must develop before attacking it repeatedly.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

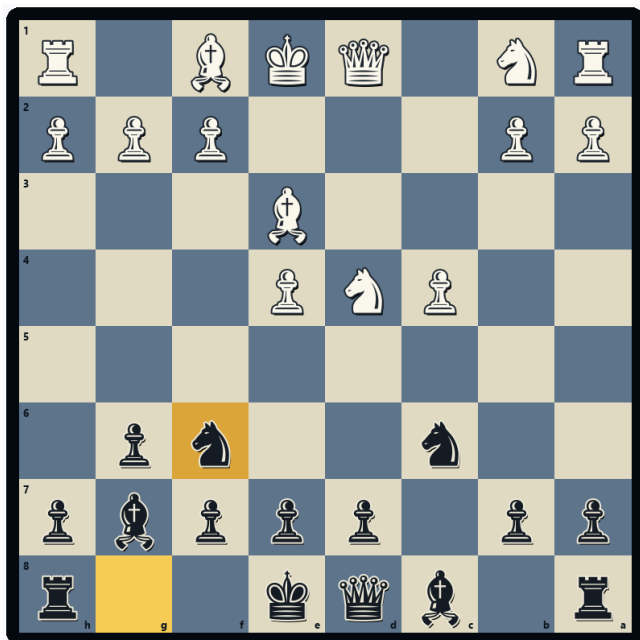
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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Exchange Dragon: open files are compensation only when rooks can reach them.

11. Hyper-Accelerated Dragon



03 - Dragon Systems

READ THE POSITION

Black fianchettoes before committing the queen knight and invites a Maroczy structure.

PRIMARY PLAN

Complete development, challenge d4, and choose ...d6 or immediate ...Nf6 according to White's center.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White uses c4 to restrict ...d5 and gain a lasting space edge.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 g6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Bg7 5. c4 Nc6 6. Be3 Nf6

MEMORY RULE

Hyper-Accelerated: flexibility matters only if it produces a useful break.

11. Decision Framework

Hyper-Accelerated Dragon

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Delaying ...Nc6 does not remove the need to calculate Qa4 and Nxc6 tactics.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

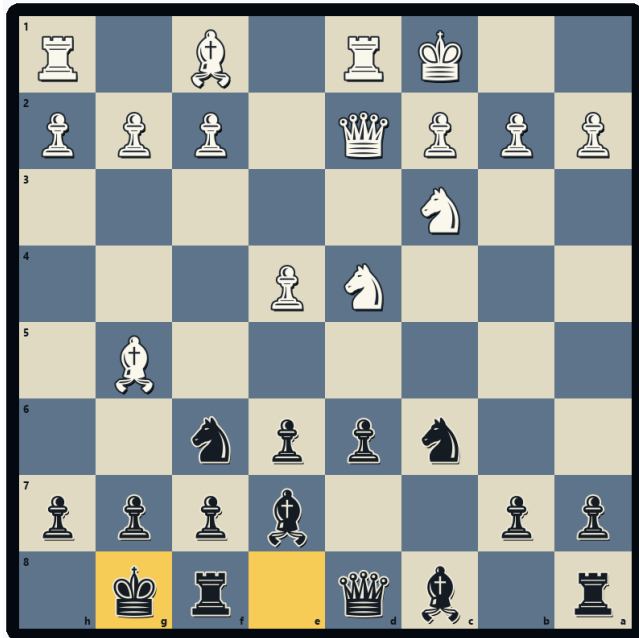
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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Hyper-Accelerated: flexibility matters only if it produces a useful break.

12. Classical Richter-Rauzer



04 - Classical and Scheveningen

READ THE POSITION

White pins, castles long, and builds central pressure while Black develops naturally with ...Nc6.

PRIMARY PLAN

Use ...Nxd4, ...a6, and ...Bd7 or ...d5 to challenge White's coordination before the attack grows.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White uses f4-f5, e5, and kingside pressure with the queens on the board.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 Nc6 6. Bg5 e6 7. Qd2 Be7 8. O-O-O O-O

MEMORY RULE

Rauzer: challenge White's center before the pin becomes an attack.

12. Decision Framework

Classical Richter-Rauzer

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	The c6-knight can be pinned to key central squares even when the king is not directly behind it.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

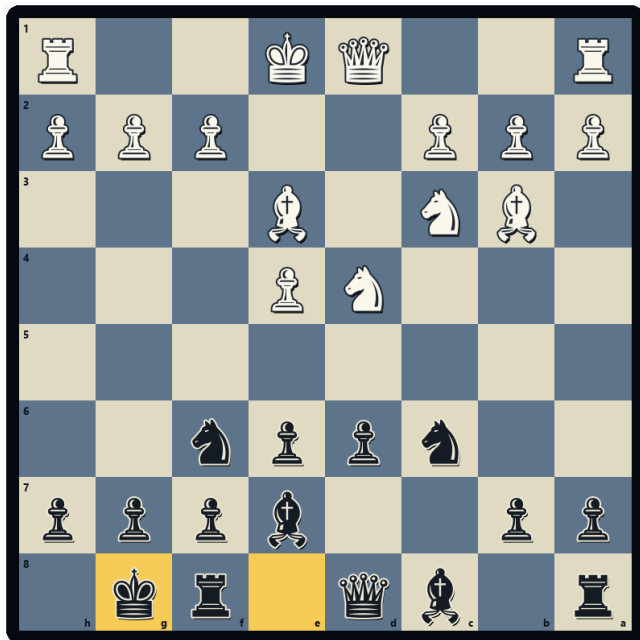
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5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Rauzer: challenge White's center before the pin becomes an attack.

13. Classical Sozin



04 - Classical and Scheveningen

READ THE POSITION

The bishop points at e6 and f7 while Black uses a compact Scheveningen center.

PRIMARY PLAN

Finish development, control d5, and use ...Na5 or ...d5 to reduce the bishop's influence.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White builds f4-f5 and sacrifices on e6 when Black's king and queen align.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 Nc6 6. Bc4 e6 7. Be3 Be7 8. Bb3 O-O

MEMORY RULE

Sozin: make the c4-bishop prove its target before starting queenside play.

13. Decision Framework

Classical Sozin

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Every ...d5 break must survive Nxc6 and e5 discoveries on the central files.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

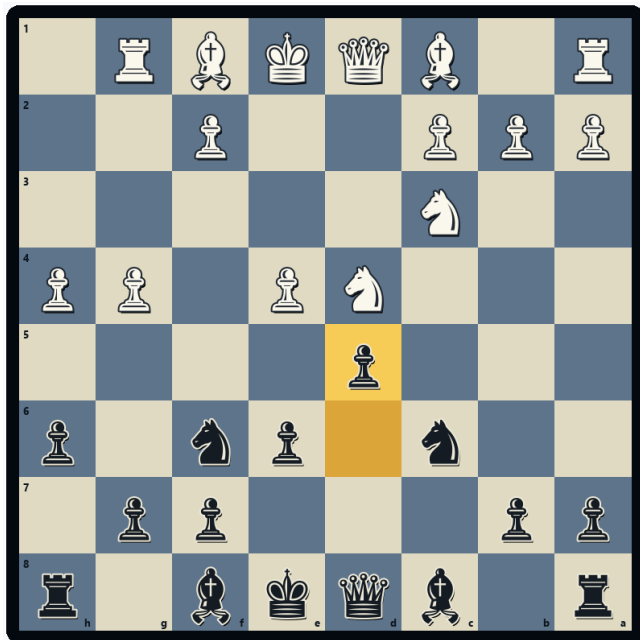
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3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Sozin: make the c4-bishop prove its target before starting queenside play.

14. Scheveningen Keres Attack



04 - Classical and Scheveningen

READ THE POSITION

White gains kingside space immediately while Black strikes in the center before castling.

PRIMARY PLAN

Use central counterplay to make the g-pawn advance irrelevant, and delay castling when the center is safe.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White seeks g5, h5, and a direct attack before Black coordinates.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 e6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 d6 6. g4 h6 7. h4 Nc6 8. Rg1 d5

MEMORY RULE

Keres Attack: answer a wing attack by opening the center on favorable terms.

14. Decision Framework

Scheveningen Keres Attack

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Castling into the prepared pawn storm can be worse than leaving the king temporarily in the center.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

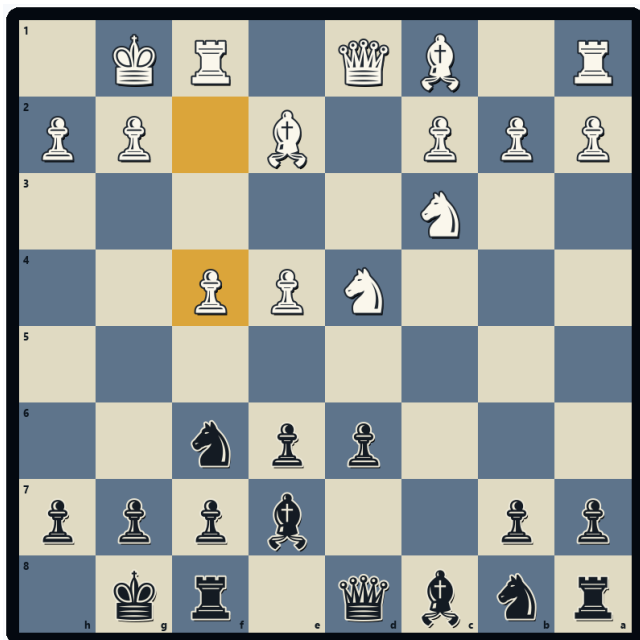
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Keres Attack: answer a wing attack by opening the center on favorable terms.

15. Scheveningen Classical



04 - Classical and Scheveningen

READ THE POSITION

Both sides develop normally before White expands with f4 and Black seeks queenside or central counterplay.

PRIMARY PLAN

Control e5, use ...Qc7 and ...Nc6, and prepare ...d5 or ...b5 without weakening the king.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White builds e5 or f5 and may transfer pieces toward the kingside.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 e6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 d6 6. Be2 Be7 7. O-O O-O 8. f4

MEMORY RULE

Scheveningen: hold e5, then free the position before White owns the kingside.

15. Decision Framework

Scheveningen Classical

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	The e6-pawn can be a tactical hook when the f-file opens.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

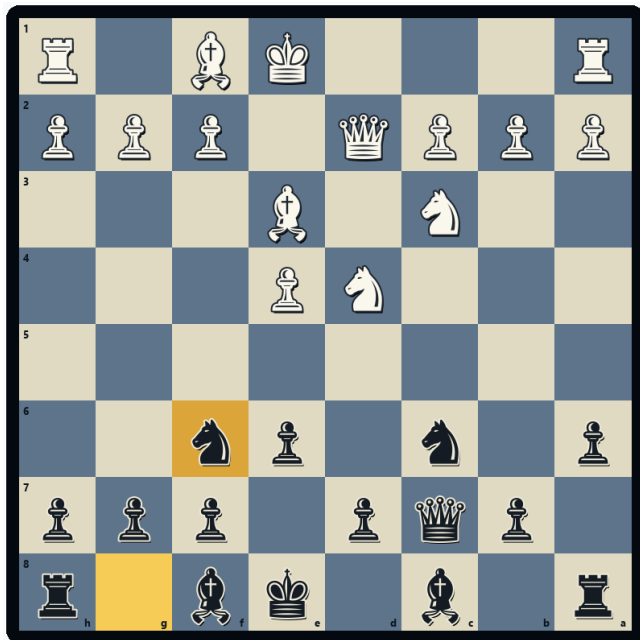
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Scheveningen: hold e5, then free the position before White owns the kingside.

16. Taimanov Main Line



05 - Taimanov Kan and Four Knights

READ THE POSITION

Black keeps both central pawn choices available and uses ...Qc7 to support flexible development.

PRIMARY PLAN

Develop with ...Nf6, ...Bb4, and ...b5 while watching Nb5 and the timing of ...d5.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White uses long castling, f3, and g4 or an early Nb5 to exploit the queen's placement.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 e6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nc6 5. Nc3 Qc7 6. Be3 a6 7. Qd2 Nf6

MEMORY RULE

Taimanov: flexibility is earned by controlling Nb5 and d5.

16. Decision Framework

Taimanov Main Line

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	The queen on c7 can be hit by Ndb5 or discovered tactics on the c-file.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

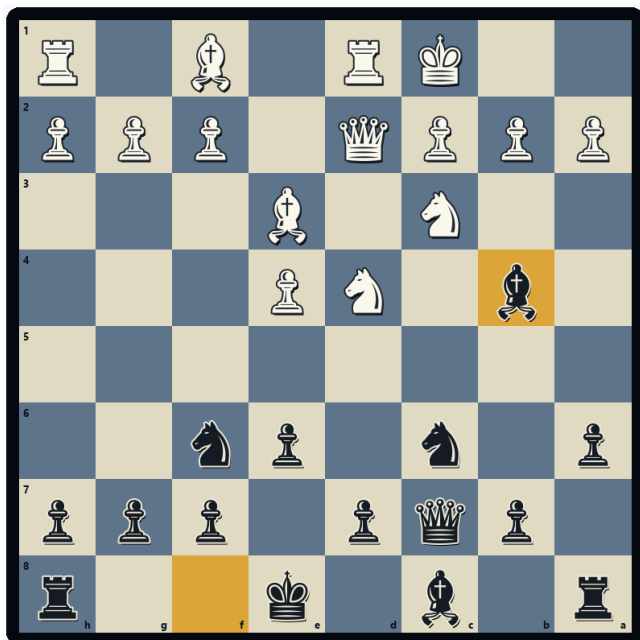
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Taimanov: flexibility is earned by controlling Nb5 and d5.

17. Taimanov English Attack



05 - Taimanov Kan and Four Knights

READ THE POSITION

White castles long while Black develops the dark bishop actively instead of copying a Najdorf setup.

PRIMARY PLAN

Use ...Bxc3 when it damages White's center, then create ...d5 or queenside pressure against the king.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White pushes f3 and g4 while using the d-file and development lead.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 e6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nc6 5. Nc3 Qc7 6. Be3 a6 7. Qd2 Nf6 8. O-O-O Bb4

MEMORY RULE

Taimanov English: create structural targets before beginning the king hunt.

17. Decision Framework

Taimanov English Attack

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	The bishop trade on c3 is useful only if Black can attack the resulting pawns.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

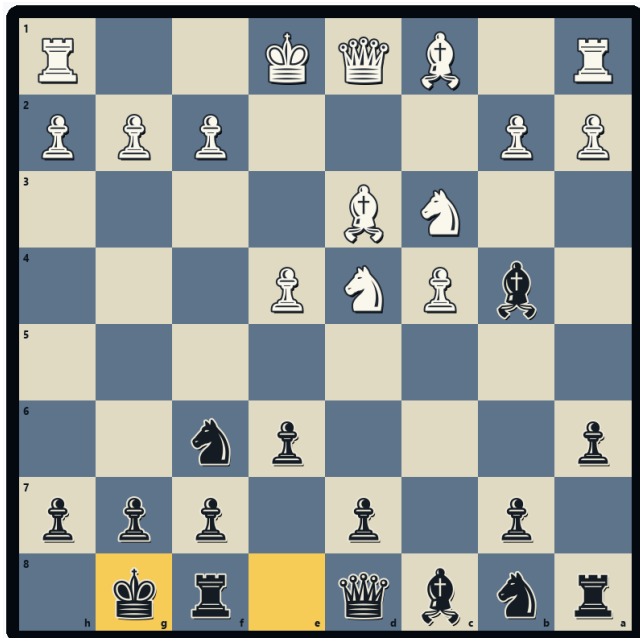
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Taimanov English: create structural targets before beginning the king hunt.

18. Kan Maroczy Structure



05 - Taimanov Kan and Four Knights

READ THE POSITION

White occupies c4 and e4 while Black uses ...a6 and piece pressure instead of an early ...d6.

PRIMARY PLAN

Pin or attack e4, prepare ...d5, and use queenside space without allowing e5 with tempo.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White maintains the bind and develops for a slow squeeze.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 e6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 a6 5. c4 Nf6 6. Nc3 Bb4 7. Bd3 O-O

MEMORY RULE

Kan Maroczy: provoke a fixed target before releasing the bishop.

18. Decision Framework

Kan Maroczy Structure

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Exchanging on c3 can strengthen White's center if Black cannot pressure c4 or e4.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

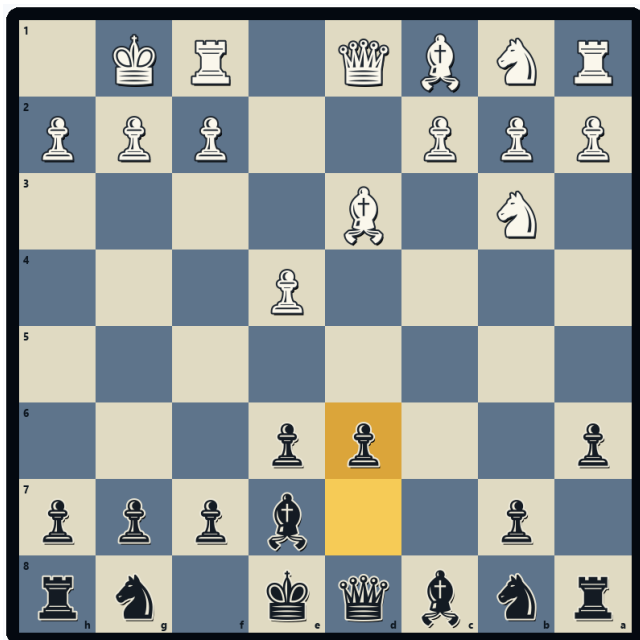
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Kan Maroczy: provoke a fixed target before releasing the bishop.

19. Kan 5.Bd3 System



05 - Taimanov Kan and Four Knights

READ THE POSITION

White develops quickly while Black gains flexible queenside control and avoids committing the b8-knight.

PRIMARY PLAN

Use ...Nf6, ...Nd7, and ...Ngf6 or ...b5 according to White's castling plan.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White can use Qg4, f4, or c4 while Black's development remains compact.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 e6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 a6 5. Bd3 Bc5 6. Nb3 Be7 7. O-O d6

MEMORY RULE

Kan Bd3: develop the bishop actively, then retreat it with a reason.

19. Decision Framework

Kan 5.Bd3 System

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	The c5-bishop can be chased with tempo and must not obstruct central development.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

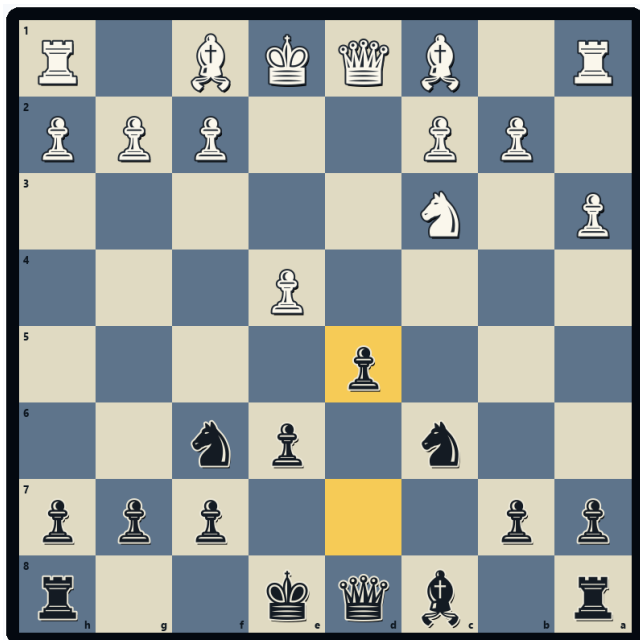
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Kan Bd3: develop the bishop actively, then retreat it with a reason.

20. Four Knights Sicilian



05 - Taimanov Kan and Four Knights

READ THE POSITION

Black develops both knights and meets White's Nb5 pressure with active central play.

PRIMARY PLAN

Use ...Bb4 and a timely ...d5 to trade White's development lead for a clean center.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White jumps to b5, pressures d6, and may gain the bishop pair.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 e6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 Nc6 6. Ndb5 Bb4 7. a3 Bxc3+ 8. Nxc3 d5

MEMORY RULE

Four Knights: the center must open before White converts the bishop pair.

20. Decision Framework

Four Knights Sicilian

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	The ...d5 break fails if the c6-knight or e6-pawn is tactically loose after exchanges.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

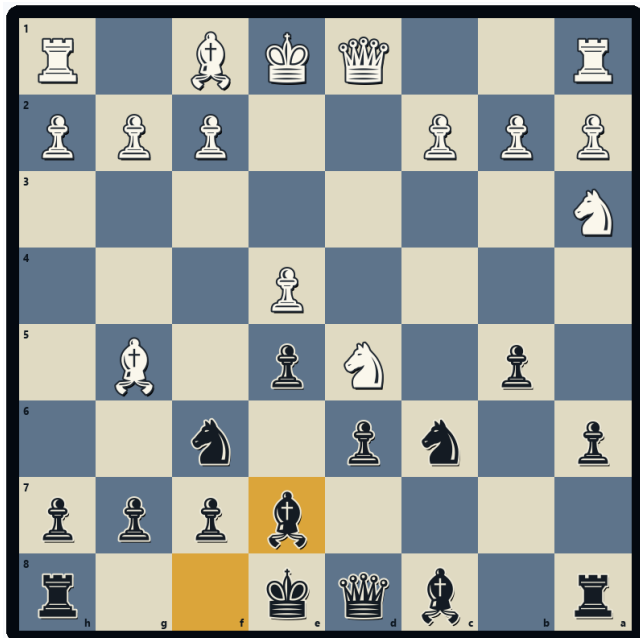
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Four Knights: the center must open before White converts the bishop pair.

21. Sveshnikov Main Tabiya



06 - Sveshnikov and Kalashnikov

READ THE POSITION

Black accepts the d5 outpost and backward d6-pawn in exchange for space, tempi, and active piece play.

PRIMARY PLAN

Challenge the d5-knight, use ...f5, and exploit the b-file and dark squares created by ...b5.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White occupies d5, pressures d6, and tries to exploit the weakened d5 and b6 squares.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 e5 6. Ndb5 d6 7. Bg5 a6 8. Na3 b5 9. Nd5 Be7

MEMORY RULE

Sveshnikov: dynamic squares and pawn breaks must compensate for d5.

21. Decision Framework

Sveshnikov Main Tabiya

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Removing the d5-knight with the wrong piece can leave a permanent hole and passive bishop.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

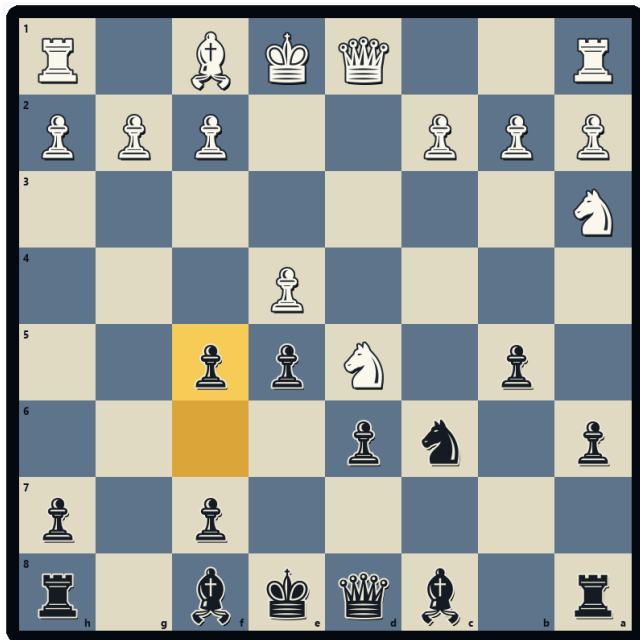
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Sveshnikov: dynamic squares and pawn breaks must compensate for d5.

22. Sveshnikov 9.Bxf6



06 - Sveshnikov and Kalashnikov

READ THE POSITION

Black accepts doubled f-pawns to obtain the bishop pair, the g-file, and immediate ...f5 play.

PRIMARY PLAN

Use ...f5 before White fixes the center, and coordinate the bishops with the open files.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White blockades d5 and targets the damaged kingside structure.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 e5 6. Ndb5 d6 7. Bg5 a6 8. Na3 b5 9. Bxf6 gxf6 10. Nd5 f5

MEMORY RULE

Sveshnikov Bxf6: damaged pawns are dynamic only while they create tempi and lines.

22. Decision Framework

Sveshnikov 9.Bxf6

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	The open g-file helps Black only if the king and queen cannot be checked through the center.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

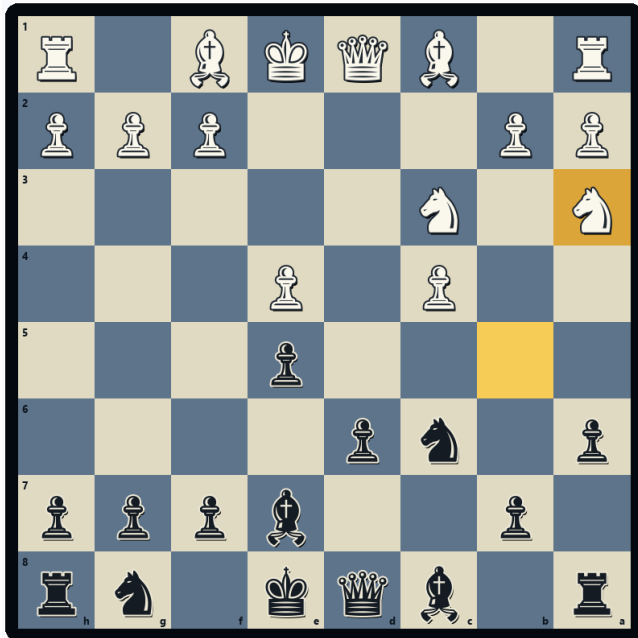
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Sveshnikov Bxf6: damaged pawns are dynamic only while they create tempi and lines.

23. Kalashnikov Maroczy Setup



06 - Sveshnikov and Kalashnikov

READ THE POSITION

Black gains e5 space without ...Nf6 and allows White a c4 bind with a knight on b5.

PRIMARY PLAN

Use ...f5, ...Nf6, and queenside expansion while preventing a permanent d5 blockade.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White controls d5 and tries to keep Black's pieces cramped behind the e5-pawn.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 e5 5. Nb5 d6 6. c4 Be7 7. N1c3 a6 8. Na3

MEMORY RULE

Kalashnikov: prepare ...f5 as a freeing break, not a reflex.

23. Decision Framework

Kalashnikov Maroczy Setup

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	A premature ...f5 can expose e6 and the king if development is incomplete.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

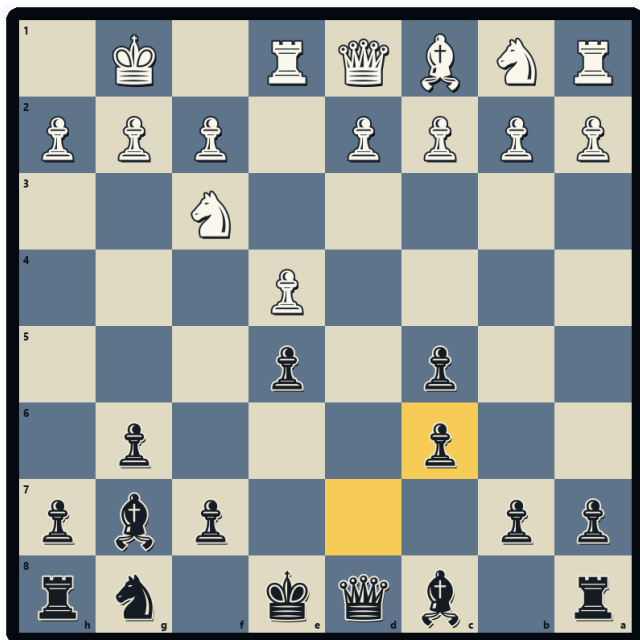
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Kalashnikov: prepare ...f5 as a freeing break, not a reflex.

24. Rossolimo with ...g6



07 - Anti-Sicilians

READ THE POSITION

White gives up the bishop to alter Black's queenside while Black builds a strong dark-square center.

PRIMARY PLAN

Use the bishop pair, control d4, and time ...Ne7, ...d6, and ...f5 without closing every diagonal.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White attacks e5 and the doubled c-pawns while keeping rapid development.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 g6 4. O-O Bg7 5. Re1 e5 6. Bxc6 dxc6

MEMORY RULE

Rossolimo: the structure is sound when the bishops and central breaks stay active.

24. Decision Framework

Rossolimo with ...g6

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	The doubled c-pawns become weak if Black allows a fixed blockade and trades the active bishop.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

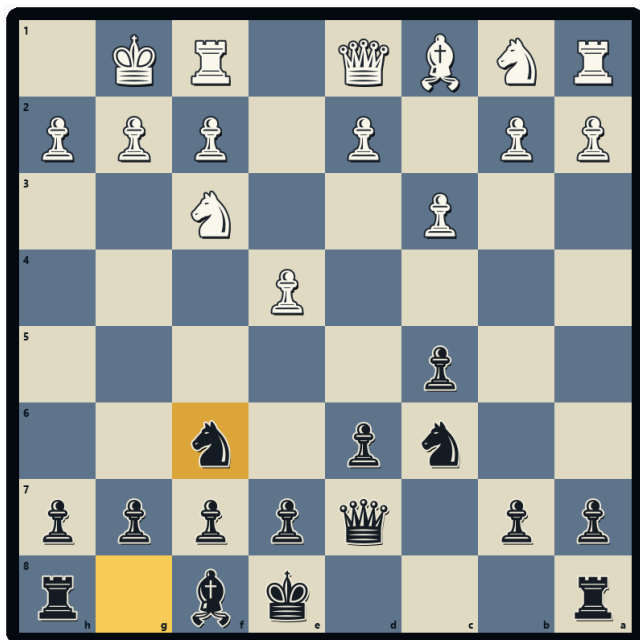
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Rossolimo: the structure is sound when the bishops and central breaks stay active.

25. Moscow Variation



07 - Anti-Sicilians

READ THE POSITION

Black accepts a bishop trade and develops the queen to keep a healthy structure.

PRIMARY PLAN

Complete development, control d5, and use ...g6 or ...e6 according to White's center.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White uses c3-d4 and hopes the queen on d7 costs Black a tempo.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. Bb5+ Bd7 4. Bxd7+ Qxd7 5. O-O Nc6 6. c3 Nf6

MEMORY RULE

Moscow: accept the bishop trade, then make the queen useful rather than vulnerable.

25. Decision Framework

Moscow Variation

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	The queen can become exposed after d4 and e5 if Black delays development.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

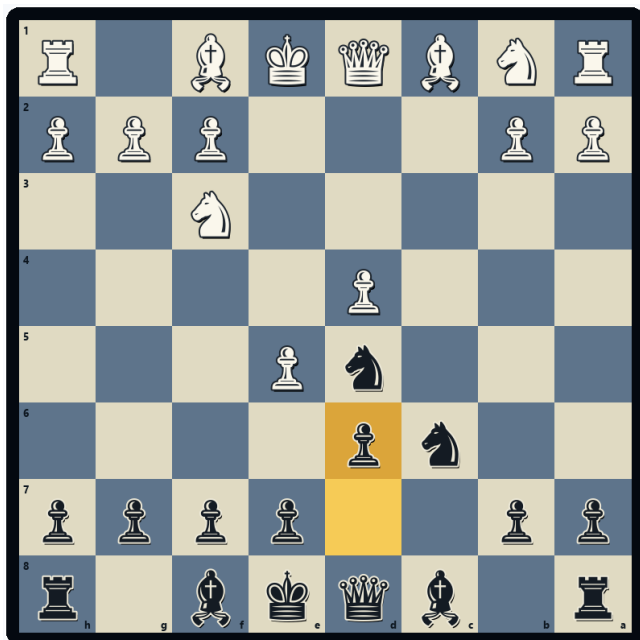
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Moscow: accept the bishop trade, then make the queen useful rather than vulnerable.

26. Alapin 2.c3



07 - Anti-Sicilians

READ THE POSITION

White builds a classical center while Black attacks it before it stabilizes.

PRIMARY PLAN

Pressure e5 and d4, develop with ...Nc6, and use ...d6 or ...d5 to force central decisions.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White gains space and tries to recapture on d4 with a piece-supported center.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. c3 Nf6 3. e5 Nd5 4. d4 cxd4 5. Nf3 Nc6 6. cxd4 d6

MEMORY RULE

Alapin: attack the center with pieces and one pawn break, not repeated pawn hunting.

26. Decision Framework

Alapin 2.c3

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Chasing the e5-pawn with too many queen moves can give White effortless development.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

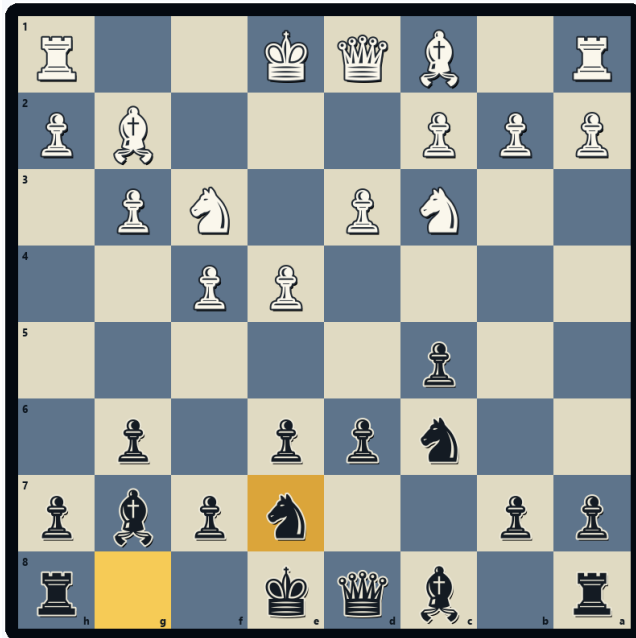
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Alapin: attack the center with pieces and one pawn break, not repeated pawn hunting.

27. Closed Sicilian



07 - Anti-Sicilians

READ THE POSITION

White keeps the center closed and builds a kingside attack while Black has time for queenside expansion.

PRIMARY PLAN

Use ...Rb8, ...b5, and a central ...d5 break while preserving king safety.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White seeks f5, g4, and a kingside squeeze without opening the center early.

REFERENCE LINE 1. e4 c5 2. Nc3 Nc6 3. g3 g6 4. Bg2 Bg7 5. d3 d6 6. f4 e6 7. Nf3 Nge7

MEMORY RULE

Closed Sicilian: counter on the queenside, but let the center choose the speed.

27. Decision Framework

Closed Sicilian

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Queenside play is too slow if Black castles into a fully prepared f5 attack.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Closed Sicilian: counter on the queenside, but let the center choose the speed.

28. Grand Prix Attack



07 - Anti-Sicilians

READ THE POSITION

White develops quickly for f5 and kingside pressure while Black uses the dark-square fianchetto.

PRIMARY PLAN

Occupy d4, blunt the c4 or b5 bishop, and strike with ...d5 when White's center is loose.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White uses Qe1-h4, f5, and direct threats against the king.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nc3 Nc6 3. f4 g6 4. Nf3 Bg7 5. Bb5 Nd4 6. O-O e6

MEMORY RULE

Grand Prix: own d4 and open the center before the attack becomes forcing.

28. Decision Framework

Grand Prix Attack

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Castling routinely can walk into f5-f6 if the center provides no counterplay.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

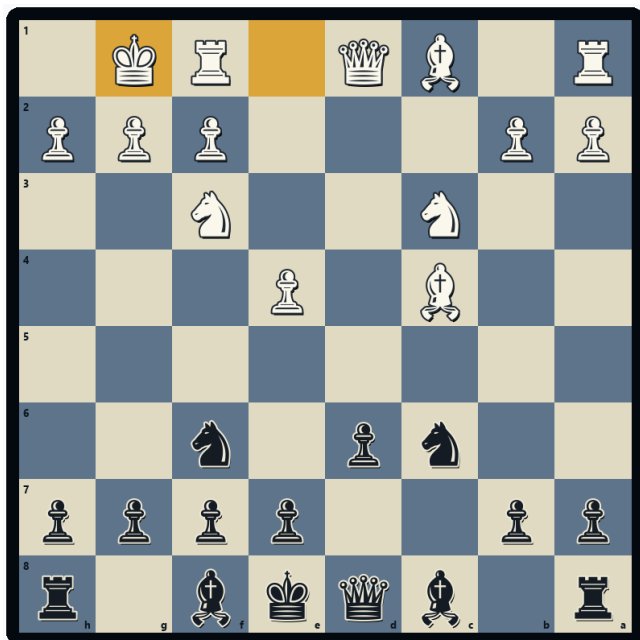
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Grand Prix: own d4 and open the center before the attack becomes forcing.

29. Smith-Morra Gambit Accepted



07 - Anti-Sicilians

READ THE POSITION

Black accepts a pawn while White receives open lines and rapid development.

PRIMARY PLAN

Complete development, return the pawn if necessary, and neutralize the c- and d-file activity before consolidating.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White uses Bc4, Qe2, Rd1, and e5 to create forcing play.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. d4 cxd4 3. c3 dxc3 4. Nxc3 Nc6 5. Nf3 d6 6. Bc4 Nf6 7. O-O

MEMORY RULE

Morra: development and king safety decide whether the extra pawn exists.

29. Decision Framework

Smith-Morra Gambit Accepted

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Trying to keep every extra pawn can leave the king in the center under a rook and bishop battery.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

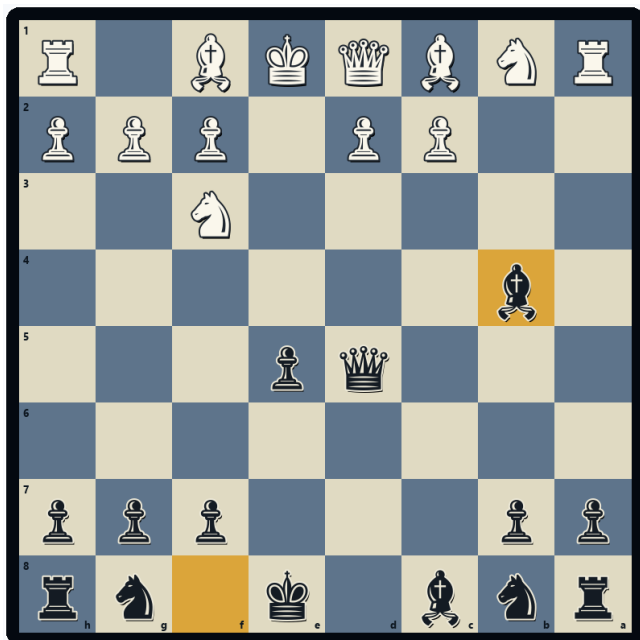
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Morra: development and king safety decide whether the extra pawn exists.

30. Wing Gambit



07 - Anti-Sicilians

READ THE POSITION

White offers the b-pawn to divert Black's c-pawn and accelerate central development.

PRIMARY PLAN

Challenge the center immediately, develop with tempo, and return material rather than defend a loose pawn.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White uses a3, d4, and rapid piece activity against the central queen and king.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. b4 cxb4 3. a3 d5 4. exd5 Qxd5 5. Nf3 e5 6. axb4 Bxb4

MEMORY RULE

Wing Gambit: use the extra pawn to buy central activity, not queen adventures.

30. Decision Framework

Wing Gambit

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	The queen on d5 can be hit by Nc3, so every pawn grab must include a retreat square.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Wing Gambit: use the extra pawn to buy central activity, not queen adventures.

Course Completion Test

Choose ten chapters at random. Rebuild each reference position, name both sides' plans, identify the critical break, and state the trade filter without reopening the chapter.

Score one point for the structure, one for your plan, one for counterplay, one for the break, and one for the memory rule. Forty out of fifty means the knowledge is usable; below forty means retrieval practice should continue.

FINAL PRINCIPLE

A course is complete when its ideas appear in your decisions, not when its pages have been read.